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The Editor
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Dear Editor,

Please find enclosed the first revision of our manuscript CAOR-D-26-01885, “*Optimal-stopping recourse for vehicle routing with simultaneous pickup, delivery, and stochastic demands.*” We thank you and the three reviewers for constructive reports. Every comment is answered point by point in the enclosed response letter, and a version of the manuscript with all changes marked is provided.

The main changes are the following.

- **Theory.** The assumptions are weakened: the load need only be a stochastically monotone Markov chain, and no ordering between handoff and emergency prices is required. A new proposition bounds the cost of over-triggering by the myopic threshold. We also corrected two errors of our own in the original propositions.
- **Machine-checked proofs.** All four propositions are now verified formally in the Lean 4 proof assistant with the Mathlib library. The formalisation compiles without unproved steps, relies only on Lean’s standard axioms, and is released with the replication code; the manuscript lists its modelling abstractions. The verification also exposed a side condition of the first proposition, now stated.
- **Stronger benchmarks.** New competitors that have the same two levers as our policy (a two-lever threshold rule and an equal-data three-action dynamic program), a position-dependent threshold, a three-action clairvoyant bound, and an exact dynamic program for independent demand, against which our policy attains 94% of the optimal saving on deterministic plans.
- **Robustness.** Dependent demand, non-exchangeable days, a capacitated standby pool shared across routes, training-data budgets, single-core timing, deliver-only customers and a depot-return fee.
- **Statistics and reporting.** The instance is the experimental unit, with paired bootstrap intervals and Holm-adjusted tests; ties and the one setting in which a competitor is ahead are reported as such, and several claims of the original version are narrowed accordingly.

Supplementary tables, one figure and one proof have moved to an appendix. All tables and figures regenerate from the public repository, which also contains the formal proofs.

The revised manuscript has not been published previously and is not under consideration elsewhere. The authors have no conflicts of interest to declare.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely, on behalf of all authors,

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